

Google Pixel 7a

Unmatched cameras under ₹50,000

The Pixel 'a' series has always been sought-after amongst Stock Android fans. The Google Pixel 7a addresses many issues users voiced with the Pixel 6a. So, is this the best smartphone you can purchase for under ₹50,000? Does it beat its competition when it comes to camera quality? Let's find out.

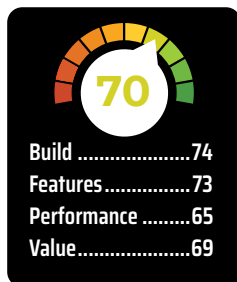
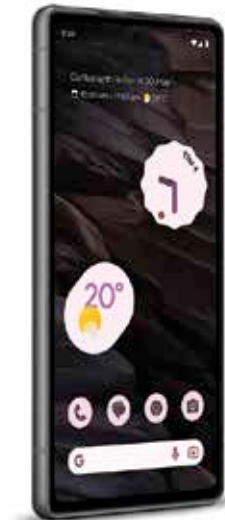
BUILD AND DESIGN

Google has slightly revamped the design of the Pixel 7a. The back panel, being glossy, does attract fingerprints, but you can't really see them on the white surface of the Snow variant. The visor-like camera module juts out slightly, but since it runs from corner to corner, there's not a lot of wobble when the phone is laid flat on a table. The sides of the phone have a slight curve which makes it comfortable to hold but the display is flat, which minimises accidental touches. The buttons on the phone are extremely well-built. They feel robust and tactile. There's an in-display optical fingerprint sensor that is quite accurate but a bit slower to respond than what I've seen on competitors. The speakers are sufficiently loud and have a good low end with minimal distortion.

DISPLAY

The Google Pixel 7a at this price, it competes with the iPhone SE (2022). The phone has Adaptive refresh rate by default and it automatically switches between 60 and 90 Hz depending on what you're doing to conserve battery. However, there are only two stops, so it can't go below 60 Hz when needed. That aside, the panel is great for content consumption. You

₹43,999



get deep blacks, close-to-natural colours, and great viewing angles. We do wish the bezels were slightly thinner for an even more immersive experience.

CAMERAS

Pixel 7a's new primary camera outputs brilliant photos in most conditions. The colours are excellent; very close to real life. It outputs some of the best natural-looking portraits in this price range. Portraits also have excellent detail retention and impressive edge detection. Ultrawide images come out looking sharp as well, especially in the centre of the image. The dynamic range isn't as strong as the main camera. The edges of the photo are also a bit soft, but this is just me nitpicking. In low light,

the Pixel 7a's camera really impressed us. Photos look sharp and detailed with minimal lens flare. Noise is very well controlled and human skin tones are very well produced at night as well. Selfie camera's shots are clear, have great dynamic range, and have true-to-life colour. The phone's videos look good in daylight but the quality takes a hit in low light. Overall this camera setup isn't rivalled by any other at this price.

PERFORMANCE

I kicked things off by running CPU benchmarks where the Pixel 7a does a decent job in its weight class. It beats most competitors at the same price except the iPhone SE 2022. In GeekBench, the pattern repeats in the Single Core test but in the Multi-Core test. The phone

pulls up decent scores in PCMark Work but it's competitors again defeat it here. Overall though, the Pixel 7a has made considerable performance gains over its predecessor. The phone also does well in GPU benchmarks. It heats up pretty quickly even if it is running relatively basic tasks. We recorded temperatures going up to 38-40 degrees Celsius after a run of the CPU Throttling Test for 15 minutes. We recorded the phone throttling to 60 per cent of its peak performance. The Stock Android Pixel experience here is bloatware-free, clean, minimalistic.

BATTERY LIFE

The battery life is still good and I recorded 13 hours and 52 minutes of battery in our 4K video loop test. As for normal usage, I easily got close to 5 hours of on-screen time with heavy usage. You can now charge the phone wirelessly on any compatible Qi charger, however, the wireless charging speeds are extremely slow. The phone is only capable of 18 W charging which is awfully dated in 2023.

VERDICT

The Google Pixel 7a embraces the strengths of previous Pixel phones and builds on them. It is, without a doubt, the best camera phone I've tested under ₹50,000. However, heat management is not up to standard. Hopefully, Google manages to fix these issues with OTA updates in the future, and if they do, we'll make sure to update you. If the Pixel 7a doesn't appeal to you but you still want a clean UI and good cameras, other options include the iPhone SE (2022) with speedier performance and Google's own Pixel 7.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Google Tensor G2 | Security coprocessor: Titan M2 | RAM: 8 GB LPDDR5 | ROM: 128 GB UFS 3.1 | Display: 6.1-inch FHD+ | Refresh rate: 90 Hz | Battery capacity: 4,385 mAh | Rear cameras: 64 MP main camera, 13 MP ultrawide camera | Front camera: 13 MP | OS: Android 13, 5 years of updates | IP Rating: IP67

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